



FUNDING PROPOSAL

DRYDOCKING, HULL SURVEY & PRESERVATION

First drydocking in over a decade: survey the hull, renew what must be renewed, blast and coat, and protect the ship for the next twenty years.

\$1,110,000

TOTAL REQUEST

Executive summary

The Foundation will drydock Comanche at a Puget Sound shipyard for a full hull survey, steel renewal, sea-valve and running-gear overhaul, and a complete blast-and-coat of the underwater and topside hull. This is the single most important preservation action available for a steel vessel and the one that has been deferred longest.

Statement of need

Steel hulls are preserved from the outside in. Comanche was last drydocked in 2013 at Stabbert Marine in Seattle; she is now well beyond the five-year interval typical for coated steel in salt water. Coatings are failing, sacrificial anodes are expended and hull-thickness data is more than a decade old. Every year deferred increases steel loss and cost. A drydocking with proper survey and coating is what keeps the ship insurable, keeps her operational, and keeps Puget Sound safe from an aging steel hull.

Project description

Scope: (1) pre-drydock survey and gauging plan; (2) transit under own power to the yard with tug assist and insurance rider; (3) drydock lay period (21 days planned); (4) full ultrasonic thickness survey and report; (5) steel renewal of plate and framing below the standard allowance (allowance for 6–8 tons); (6) sea chests, hull valves, through-hulls and anode renewal; (7) shaft, stern tube, rudder and propeller inspection and repair; (8) full abrasive blast and multi-coat marine coating system on the underwater hull, boot-top and topsides; (9) tank cleaning and gas-freeing for hot work; (10) an owner's representative to manage the yard period. Volunteers will perform prep, staging and topside work permitted by the yard to reduce cost.

Goals & measurable objectives

- Vessel drydocked, surveyed and returned to the water within the planned yard period.
- UT survey report establishing a hull-thickness baseline for the next 20 years.
- All steel below allowance renewed; all sea valves and anodes renewed.
- Complete coating system applied with manufacturer inspection sign-off.

- Hull condition documented before/after for public interpretation.

Timeline

Months 1–3	Yard bids, pre-survey, gauging plan, insurance and transit plan.
Month 4	Transit to yard; drydock.
Months 4–5	Survey, steel renewal, valves, running gear, blast and coat.
Month 5	Undock, sea trial, return to home berth.
Month 6	Final report, photo record, public exhibit.

Budget

Pre-drydock survey, gauging plan, yard specification	\$22,000
Transit to and from yard: fuel, tug assist, pilotage, crew, insurance rider	\$34,000
Drydock lay days, 21 days including dock fees, blocking, utilities	\$135,000
Ultrasonic thickness survey and report	\$26,000
Steel renewal allowance (plate and framing, 6–8 tons, incl. labor)	\$190,000
Sea chests, hull valves, through-hulls, anodes	\$48,000
Shaft, stern tube, rudder and propeller inspection and repair	\$65,000
Abrasive blast and marine coating system, underwater hull and topsides	\$250,000
Tank cleaning, gas-freeing and hot-work safety	\$32,000
Owner’s representative / yard-period project management	\$42,000
Coatings inspection and documentation	\$9,000
Direct costs	\$853,000
Contingency (30%)	\$255,900
Total project cost	\$1,108,900

Amount requested (rounded) **\$1,110,000**

Budget lines are order-of-magnitude planning figures for a 133.4 ft / 295 GT steel vessel on Puget Sound, deliberately conservative so the funded scope can be delivered in full; they are replaced with vendor quotes at application. Unused contingency is returned or reallocated with funder approval. Partial funding is welcome and combinable with other sources.

In-kind and match. Volunteer crew for transit and yard-period support; volunteer prep and topside labor as permitted by the yard (est. 1,500 hours); donated or discounted coatings sought from manufacturers.

Evaluation

- Yard completion report and invoices reconciled to scope.

Funder fit

- Washington Heritage Capital Projects Fund (Legislature, biennial)
- National Trust / National Maritime Heritage Grants

- UT survey report and coating inspection certificate on file.
- Independent surveyor sign-off at undocking.
- Before/after documentation published.
- 4Culture Building for Culture
- Maritime industry sponsors (shipyards, coatings, steel)
- Major private foundations

Sustainability

A properly coated hull with fresh anodes sets a 7–10 year interval to the next drydocking; the Foundation will fund a drydock reserve from operations and sponsorships beginning the year after completion.

Organization overview

Tug Comanche Historical Rescue Foundation (EIN 39-5018917) is a Washington nonprofit based in Auburn, Washington, listed on the IRS Publication 78 data list as eligible to receive tax-deductible charitable contributions (deductibility code PC). The Foundation preserves the historic vessel Comanche — laid down in 1944 as the U.S. Navy ocean tug ATA-202, later USS Wampanoag and Coast Guard cutter WMEC-202 — and operates her as a living platform for maritime heritage, hands-on education, youth mentorship, restoration-skills exposure, veteran and mariner storytelling, Puget Sound stewardship, and community service. Comanche is one of the last operational WWII museum ships in the world, still moving under her own power with an all-volunteer crew. The organization is governed by a volunteer board of directors and delivers its programs through volunteers, maritime-trades mentors and community partners.

Vessel history & significance

Comanche is a rare surviving example of a WWII-era U.S. Navy auxiliary ocean tug. Completed in 1944 and commissioned as ATA-202, she was named USS Wampanoag in 1948 and later served as the U.S. Coast Guard cutter WMEC-202 before becoming known as Comanche. Her current U.S. Coast Guard Certificate of Documentation (Official Number 647250; IMO 8991786) records a steel-hulled, mechanically propelled vessel of 133.4 feet registered length, 33.1-foot breadth, 17.7-foot depth, 295 gross tons and 200 net tons (ITC), hailing port Seattle, Washington. She is propelled by two Cleveland Diesel 12-cylinder diesel-electric main engines driving a single screw, and holds a world record as the last ship still steered by deck-tube chain rudder control.

Legal & operating boundary. Comanche does not hold a U.S. Coast Guard Certificate of Inspection for commercial passenger service. No grant funds, fees or donations are or will be used for paid carriage, charters, towing, freight or any underway commercial service. Public programs take place alongside the pier; cruises occur only in partnership with other nonprofit and community organizations, never as a charter, and the Foundation retains control of the vessel at all times.

Contact: Wesley Weaver, Secretary — info@tug202.org — tug202.org · The web version of this proposal, with the latest figures, is at tug202.org/grants/drydock-hull-preservation.